

is the lens collar, used mostly for large telephoto lenses, and is an attachment that fits around the lens somewhere near the base or middle section. Then the head directly attaches to the collar itself instead of to the camera body, causing the camera plus lens to rest on the tripod at a location much closer to their centre of mass, placing lesser torque, and helping it function without creeping and slipping. A lens collar can also make a big difference in how susceptible the tripod and head are to vibrations. The next important constructional feature to consider is the material of the tripods, which are most commonly made of aluminum and carbon fiber but can also use steel, wood or plastic. Though aluminum ones are cheaper than their fiber counterparts, they are also a lot heavier for the same amount of stability and can be uncomfortably cold to handle with bare hands in cold weather conditions. Fiber ones generally provide better dampening of vibrations too.

Now that we are familiar with the built of tripods, let us dive deeper into their uses and handling. The basic function of a tripod is fairly simple—to hold the camera precisely, producing a sharp image without blurring, but its uses and advantages go way beyond just holding a camera steady. Several specialty techniques require the use of tripods, like taking a series of photos at different angles to produce a digital panorama, click photos at different exposures for high dynamic range (HDR) images, or take series of time lapse photographs to produce an animation among others. Whenever you want to precisely control your composition or need the camera in the right composition well in advance of the shot, such as in sporting events, a tripod comes to your rescue. When taking a series of photos to produce a composite image, such as selectively including people in a crowd or combining portions lit by daylight with those at dusk, it's a tripod that makes the job possible.

So, without doubt, you can get a lot out of your tripod by experimenting with different styles and techniques, but when choosing a tripod, what should your considerations be and what competing factors



Weight is an important consideration